

7-1 Final Project: Sprint Review and Retrospective

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Software Development Lifecycle

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For the SNHU Travel project, I worked through simulations that modeled Agile development in a realistic way. Although I wasn't part of a live team, I participated in animated meetings and role-based scenarios that showed how a Scrum team collaborates and adapts. Throughout the course, I took on all four Scrum roles: Scrum Master, Product Owner, Developer, and Tester. This retrospective focuses on my perspective as the Scrum Master. It reflects on how the team operated, how Scrum practices supported progress, and what I learned from the experience.

This Sprint Review and Retrospective summarizes how each role contributed to the success of the simulated project. My focus throughout was on supporting the team, encouraging clear communication, and applying Agile principles during each phase of the sprint. The Product Owner led a focus group that resulted in five detailed user stories. What stood out was how the customers built on each other's feedback. One idea often sparked another, revealing needs that weren't obvious at first—like customizing top destinations based on travel history or setting profile filters by travel type and budget. This early stakeholder input gave the team valuable insight and shaped a stronger backlog.

When priorities shifted mid-sprint from general travel destinations to wellness retreats, the Developer was able to reuse the existing slideshow structure and simply update the content and layout. This adjustment kept the project on track while improving accessibility and alignment with the new goals. On the testing side, story assumptions didn't always match the UI, but the Tester followed up with the Product Owner to clarify expectations. That communication helped make sure testing reflected real user behavior and not just a checklist of features.

User stories were the foundation of the sprint, and I saw how the Agile process helped bring them to completion. The focus group sparked detailed conversation and led to well-defined stories with clear acceptance criteria. Before sprint planning, the team broke each story down by complexity, using Planning Poker to estimate effort. During the sprint, Backlog Refinement gave us space to adjust and clarify stories when needed. Daily Standups helped surface any blockers early. Because of that structure, the Developer was able to deliver features incrementally, and the Tester used the criteria to build meaningful test cases. The process supported a steady path from initial feedback to working software.

Mid-sprint, the project pivoted from general travel to wellness-focused content. That change, along with an earlier layout assumption (list view vs. slideshow), could have stalled progress. Instead, the Scrum process gave us a rhythm to manage the shift. In Daily Standups, the team raised questions early. After some clarification, we confirmed that the existing structure could remain in place, and we adjusted the scope in Backlog Refinement to make room for new content. These moments were a reminder that change is expected in Agile. The key is having a structure that allows for quick realignment without losing momentum.

Throughout the simulation, clear communication helped the team stay aligned and avoid assumptions. I had opportunities to write realistic messages across roles, which helped bridge gaps in understanding. For example, while testing the “Filter by Price” feature, the layout didn’t match the original story. To clarify, the Tester sent this message to the Product Owner:

Hi Christy,

As I write the test case for the “Filter by Price” feature, I noticed that the current slideshow UI doesn’t appear to include any visible filter input (like a slider or text box). Can you clarify whether this is a planned feature for a later stage, or if we should expect a backend filter that updates results in the background? Also, how should users interact with the filter—will it apply automatically, or require a submit action?

Thanks,

Felie

This message was effective because it focused on a specific issue and raised it early. It also helped align testing with the actual experience users would have.

In another example, the Developer sent a message requesting clarification on content tone and layout behavior:

Hi Team,

I’ve implemented the slideshow and updated all images and descriptions to reflect the new wellness direction. I would like confirmation on the tone for each destination. For example, should we focus more on luxury or on the healing benefits? Additionally, I would appreciate any testing feedback on how the UI behaves when resized, especially if the text or images become unreadable. Please let me know your thoughts so I can make the appropriate adjustments before submission.

Thanks,

Felie

These types of exchanges helped the team stay in sync across roles and avoid unnecessary rework.

Scrum events and visual tools played a key role in keeping the team organized. Sprint Planning, Daily Standups, and Retrospectives provided structure and kept the team focused. Between events, a Trello-style Kanban board helped track tasks and visualize workflow. It also supported Backlog Refinement by making it easy to see which items were ready and which needed more clarity. Even in a simulated environment, combining structured events with simple visual tools made a noticeable impact. It increased transparency and helped everyone stay engaged.

Evaluating Agile Process

Pros:

- Adapted quickly when priorities shifted (e.g., wellness retreat pivot)
- Scrum events created structure and accountability
- Continuous feedback helped the team stay aligned
- Identified blockers early and allowed reprioritization through Backlog Refinement

Cons:

- Some user stories were vague and needed clarification mid-sprint
- GUI layout assumptions led to delays in testing alignment
- Required ongoing clarification between roles to avoid misinterpretation
- Simulated setup sometimes lacked the context of real-time collaboration

Scrum-Agile was clearly the right fit for this project. The framework supported feedback, flexibility, and steady delivery. Even without a live team, the structure of

Scrum helped guide progress and create opportunities for learning. It allowed the team to respond to change, align on goals, and improve incrementally with each sprint.

Looking back, the Scrum-Agile approach helped the team stay focused, flexible, and connected to the project's evolving needs. The simulation showed how each role plays a part in moving the sprint forward, and how structured communication keeps everyone aligned. What stood out the most was the importance of surfacing blockers early, clarifying assumptions, and adjusting priorities without slowing down. Agile isn't just about working fast. It's about working together to deliver the right thing, one step at a time.